

Static GK Test -5

Q1. Thrissur Pooram is one of the famous temple festivals celebrated in _____.

- A) Andhra Pradesh
- B) Kerala**
- C) Karnataka
- D) Tamil Nadu

Solution: 11.(b) Kerala. Thrissur Pooram is celebrated in the Malayalam month of Medam (April-May). Other festivals: Kerala - Onam, Vishu, Attukal Pongala. Andhra Pradesh - Ugadi, Lumbini Festival . Karnataka - Kambala, Pattadakal, Dussehra (nada habba or 'state festival'), Ugadi. Tamil Nadu - Pongal, Natyanjali.

Q2. "The Inheritance of Loss" is written by which of the following authors?

- A) Jhumpa Lahiri
- B) Amitav Ghosh
- C) Kiran Desai**
- D) Anita Desai

Solution: 13.(c) Kiran Desai books :- "The Inheritance of Loss (Man Booker prize 2006)", "Hullabaloo in the Guava Orchard", "Emblems of Transformation", "India Pack - 2003", WinQSB. Some other authors and Books:- Jhumpa Lahiri - "The Namesake" and "Interpreter of Maladies". Amitav Ghosh - "The Glass Palace" and "Sea of Poppies". Anita Desai - "Clear Light of Day" and "Fasting, Feasting".

Q3. Someity is related to which of the following events?

- A) Tokyo Olympics 2020
- B) Winter Olympics 2022
- C) Commonwealth games 2022
- D) Tokyo paralympic 2020**

Solution: 5.(d) Tokyo Paralympics 2020. Someity - is the official mascot of the 2020 Summer Paralympics, Tokyo. Someity, is a figure with pink-checked patterns inspired by cherry blossoms and also the Games' official logo. Someity is named after someiyoshino, a type of cherry blossom. Miraitowa - The official mascot of the 2020 Summer Olympics, Tokyo. Miraitowa, is a figure with blue-checked patterns inspired by the Games' official logo.

Q4. In which year was the 1st winter edition of the Olympic Games organized?

- A) 1926
- B) 1920
- C) 1922
- D) 1924**

Solution: 2.(d) 1924 (Chamonix, France). American Charles Jewtraw became the first Gold medalist in the 1st Winter Olympic Games. The first Paralympic Games was held in 1960 at Rome, Italy. 2024 Summer Olympics - Paris (France), 2026 Winter Olympics (Host city - Milan and Cortina d'Ampezzo, Italy), 2028 Summer Olympics - Los Angeles (United States).

Q5. Shivaputra Siddaramaiah Komkalimath is the original name of which of the following Indian classical singers?

- A) Pandit Omkarnath Thakur
- B) Pandit Kumar Gandharva**
- C) Pandit Jasraj
- D) Pandit Dinkar Kaikini

Solution: 4.(b) Pandit Kumar Gandharva. Awards - Padma Vibhushan (1990). Pandit Omkarnath Thakur (Pranav Rang) - An influential Indian educator, musicologist and Hindustani Classical Vocalist. Pandit Jasraj (Rasraj) - An Indian Classical vocalist and was associated with Mewati Gharana. Other famous Indian classical singers - M.S. Subbulakshmi, Gangubai Hangal, Kesarbai Kerkar, Pandit Bhimsen Joshi, Ustad Bade Ghulam Ali Khan, K. J. Yesudas, Shubha Mudgal.

Q6. In 2002, Zakir Hussain became the youngest percussionist to be honoured with which award?

- A) Sangeet Natak Akademi Award
- B) Grammy Award
- C) Padma Bhushan**
- D) National Heritage Fellowship

Solution: 1.(c) Padma Bhushan. Ustad Zakir Hussain is the eldest son of tabla player Alla Rakha. His Awards: Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1991), Padma Shri (1988), Padma Vibhushan (2023). He won three Grammys at the 66th Annual Grammy Awards in 2024. Indian tabla players: Pandit Shankar Ghosh, Pandit Udhai Mazumdar, Nandan Mehta, Pandit Swapan Chaudhuri, Pandit Vijay Ghatge.

Q7. Srimanta Sankardev is generally acknowledged with pioneering new musical, dramatic, and linguistic forms. He is associated with which of the following dance forms?

- A) Manipuri
- B) Kathakali
- C) Odissi
- D) Sattriya**

Solution: 4.(d) Sattriya. It is a classical dance of Assam. Some other dances and related artists :- Mohiniyattam (Kerala) - Sunanda Nair, Kalamandalam. Odissi (Odisha) - Indrani Rehman, Guru Pankaj Charan Das, Kelu Charan Mohapatra. Kathakali (Kerala) - V. N. Menon, Guru Kunchu Kurup, Gopinath. Kathak (Northern India) - Lady Leela Sokhey, Birju Maharaj, Lacchu Maharaj, Sitara Devi, Damyanti Joshi. Manipuri (Manipur) - Raja bhag Chandra, Nayana, Suvarna, Ranjana. Bharatanatyam (Tamil Nadu) - E. Krishna Iyer, Rukmini Devi Arindal. Kuchipudi (Andhra Pradesh) - Ragini Devi, Radha Reddy And Raja Reddy.

Q8. Rukmini Devi Arundale was a famous exponent of which form of dance?

- A) Bharatnatyam**
- B) Kuchipudi
- C) Mohiniattam
- D) Kathakali

Solution: 4.(a) Bharatnatyam. Rukmini Devi Arundale: Awards - Padma Bhushan (1956), Sangeet Natak Akademi Fellowship (1967), Prani Mitra (1968), Friend of All Animals, (Animal Welfare Board of India), Kalidas Samman (1984, by govt. of Madhya Pradesh). Famous exponents - Kuchipudi (Vedantam Lakshminarayana Sastri, Vempati Venkatanarayana Sastri and Chinta Venkataramayya), Mohiniyattam - Sunanda Nair, Kalamandalam Kalyanikutty Amma, Jayaprabha Menon, Pallavi Krishnan, Kathakali - Kalamandalam Gopi, Kalamandalam Krishna Prasad.

Q9. Which is the oldest tennis tournament in the world?

- A) French Open
- B) US Open
- C) Wimbledon**
- D) Australian Open

Solution: 8.(c) Wimbledon -The tournament dates back to 1877. Wimbledon is the oldest and most prestigious grass court Grand Slam tennis tournament, believed to be the oldest active tennis tournament globally, and is held from late June to early July each year. US Open - This tournament was started in 1881 AD, French Open (Roland Garros tournament) - This tournament was started in 1891, Australian Open - This tournament was started in 1905 AD.

Q10. 'Chhau' is a popular dance of which of the following state?

- A) Gujarat
- B) Haryana
- C) Jharkhand**
- D) Kerala

Solution: 8.(c) Jharkhand. Chhau is a semi-classical Indian dance with martial and folk traditions. It is found in three styles named after the location where they are performed, i.e., the Purulia Chhau of West Bengal, the Seraikella Chhau of Jharkhand and the Mayurbhanj Chhau of Odisha. The Cultural Ministry of India has included Chhau in the list of classical dances making a total of 9 classical dance forms.

Q11. In MS Word, which feature allows you to create different headers and footers for odd and even pages in a document?

- A) Different Odd & Even Pages
- B) Page Breaks
- C) Section Breaks
- D) Different First Page

Solution: 1.(a) Different Odd & Even Pages. Microsoft Word is a word processor program developed by Microsoft. It was first released on October 25, 1983, under the name Multi-Tool Word for Xenix systems. Initial release - October 25, 1983.

Q12. When was the Pradhan Mantri Ujjwala Yojana launched by the Government of India?

- A) 2018
- B) 2014
- C) 2016
- D) 2012

Solution: 1.(c) 2016. Pradhan Mantri Ujjwala Yojana - Launched by Prime Minister Narendra Modi. Implemented by the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas through its Oil Marketing Companies. Aim - To provide LPG connections to BPL households in the country.

Q13. Gangaur Festival, Pushkar Fair, Nagaur Fair and Urs Fair are the popular fairs and festivals of which state?

- A) Rajasthan
- B) Tripura
- C) Punjab
- D) Maharashtra

Solution: 8.(a) Rajasthan. Other fairs and festivals in Rajasthan: Camel Festival, Mahaveerji Fair, Baneshwar Fair, Kolayat Fair, Marwar Festival, and Dhulandi Festival. Fairs and Festivals of India: Tripura - Poush Sankranti, Garia, and Kharchi. Punjab - Chhappar Mela, Lohri, Hola Mohalla, and Baisakhi. Maharashtra - Banganga Festival, and Pola Festival.

Q14. Which of the following is the festival of Kerala that heralds the harvest season, lasts for 10 days, and has snake boat races etc?

- A) Vishu
- B) Thiruvathira
- C) Thrissur Pooram
- D) Onam

Solution: 14.(d) Onam. Onam is the biggest festival in the Indian state of Kerala. Onam Festival falls during the Malayali month of Chingam (Aug - Sep) and marks the homecoming of legendary King Mahabali. Other Festivals of Kerala : Thrissur Pooram Festival, Attukal Pongala Festival, Navarathri Festival, Makaravilakku Festival, Kerala Village Fair, Aluva Sivarathri Festival, Vishu Festival.

Q15. In which year was the Digital India mission launched?

- A) 2014
- B) 2016
- C) 2015
- D) 2017

Solution: 5.(c) 2015. The Digital India programme was launched by Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi. Aim : To transform India into a knowledge-based economy and a digitally empowered society by ensuring digital services, digital access, digital inclusion, digital empowerment and bridging the digital divide. Coordinated by : Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology.

Q16. Pung Cholom is performed usually on religious occasions to the accompaniment of songs and dhol. It is famously performed in which of the following states?

- A) Uttar Pradesh
- B) Maharashtra
- C) Manipur
- D) Kerala

Solution: 3.(c) Manipur. Pung Cholom (folk dance of Manipur): "Pung cholom" literally means "roar of the drums". It is the soul of Manipuri

Sankirtana music. It borrows elements from the Manipuri martial arts Thang Ta and Sarit Sarak. Other dances of Manipur - Nata-Sankirtan, Dhola Cholam, Kartal Cholam, Thang ta (martial art form).

Q17. The term 'Straight drive' is related to which of the following sports?

- A) Hockey
- B) Cricket
- C) Football
- D) Badminton

Solution: 7.(b) Cricket. Other terminologies : Cricket- Beamer, Belter, Chinaman, Chucker, Dolly, Doosra, Duck, Googly, Maiden, Mankad, Nurdle, Paddle etc. Hockey - Center forward, Forward, Boarding, Goaltender, Hockey Puck, Snapshot. Football - Kick, Goal, Head, Penalty kick, Dribble, Offside, Move, Hattrick, Foul, Left out, Right out, Stopper. Badminton - Back Alley, Backcourt, Baseline.

Q18. FTX Crypto Cup is associated with which of the following sports events?

- A) Snooker
- B) Chess
- C) Billiards
- D) Golf

Solution: 3.(b) Chess. Sports with other Cups/Trophies: Snooker - World Snooker Championship, Scottish Open, World Grand Prix. Billiards - Arthur Walker Trophy. Golf - Ryder Cup, Walker Cup, Solheim Cup, Prince of Wales Cup. Polo - Ezar Cup, President Cup. Tennis - Ambre Solaire Cup, ATP President's Cup, Watson's Water Trophy, Wightman Cup. Football - African Nations Cup, McDowell Cup, Merdeka Cup.

Q19. Ustad Zia Mohiuddin Dagar was a _____ player of profound depth, favouring sparse and slow realisations of ragas.

- A) Sitar
- B) Violin
- C) Flute
- D) Rudra veena

Solution: 12.(d) Rudra veena. Zia Mohiuddin Dagar received the Sangeet Natak Akademi Award in 1981. Other Maestro: Rudra veena - Ustad Ali Zaki Hader, Asad Ali Khan, Mohammed Khan Faridi. Sitar - Ustad Vilayat Khan, Pt Ravi Shankar, Nikhil Banerjee. Violin - V.V. Subrahmanyam, T. N. Krishnan, Tirukkodikaval Krishna Iyer. Flute - Hariprasad Chaurasia, Chetan Joshi, Ronu Mazumdar.

Q20. Under the Rail Kaushal Vikas Yojana launched in September 2021, the Government of India has proposed to impart training to a total of 50,000 candidates over a _____ year period.

- A) four
- B) two
- C) five
- D) three

Solution: 10.(d) Three. Rail Kaushal Vikas Yojana {launched by Ashwini Vaishnaw (Minister of Railways and Minister of Communication Communications)} is a program under Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana (PMKVY). It was to provide training for 1000 (initial phase) candidates in four trades - Electrician, Welder, Machinist and Fitter. PMKVY was launched on 15th July, 2015 (World Youth Skills Day) by The Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship.

Q21. Who among the following personalities is associated with the musical instrument Mandolin?

- A) Brij Bhushan Kabra
- B) Vishwa Mohan Bhat
- C) U Srinivas
- D) MS Gopalkrishnan

Solution: 3.(c) U Srinivas (Uppalapu Srinivas) - He was an Indian mandolin player in Carnatic classical music. Awards: Padma Shri (1998), Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (2009). Some other musicians and instruments: Brij Bhushan Kabra (Gitar), MS Gopalkrishnan (violin), Vishwa Mohan Bhat {Mohan veena (slide guitar)}.

Q22. Giddha and Bhagra are the folk dances of which Indian state?

- A) Punjab**
- B) Gujarat
- C) Jharkhand
- D) Bihar

Solution: 15.(a) Punjab. Folk dances of Indian States : Punjab - Malawi, Julli, Sammi, Jaaga, Dhankara, Luddi. Gujarat - Garba, Dandiya, Bhavai, Tippi, Padhar, Hoodo. Jharkhand - Chhau, Paika, Khadia, Kadsa, Nagpuri, Birohr, Manbhum Chau, Hunta, Karma, Barao, Jhenana, Jhitka and Danga, Ghora Naach. Bihar - Bidesia, Jat-Jatin, Jumari, Jhijhian, Kajari. Himachal Pradesh - Nati, Dangi, Chhanak Chham, Demon (Rakshasa), Kayang Mala, Dhure.

Q23. MS Subbulakshmi, a legend in India is known for which of the following?

- A) Ghazal music
- B) Sufi devotional music
- C) Hindustani music
- D) Carnatic music**

Solution: 9.(d) Carnatic Music. M.S Subbulakshmi received her training in Hindustani classical music from 'Pandit Narayanrao Vyas'. Awards - First Musician to receive Bharat Ratna (1998), Padma Bhushan (1954), Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1956), Sangeetha Kalanidhi (1968), Ramon Magsaysay award (1974), Padma Vibhushan (1975).

Q24. Who is the only Indian woman who has been ranked world's no.1 for badminton?

- A) Saina Nehwal**
- B) Rituparna Das
- C) Jwala Gutta
- D) P V Sindhu

Solution: 6.(a) Saina Nehwal. Other Indian Badminton Players: Kidambi Srikanth, Prakash Padukone, Sai Praneeth, Pullela Gopichand, Parupalli Kashyap, Ashwini Ponnappa, Satwiksairaj Rankireddy, Chirag Shetty. Major tournaments: BWF World Championships, Thomas Cup, Uber Cup, Sudirman Cup

Q25. Santhal community is an ethnic group of _____ India.

- A) eastern**
- B) northern
- C) southern
- D) western

Solution: 6. (a) Eastern. Santhal community is primarily found in the states of Jharkhand, West Bengal, Odisha, and Bihar. On the basis of ecology, five distinct regions namely, Himalayan region (Gaddi, the Jaunsari, the Naga, etc.), Middle India (Munda, the Santal), Western India (Bhil, the Grasia), South Indian Region (Toda, the Chenchu) and the Islands Region (with tribes like the Onge in Bay of Bengal). Bhil is the largest tribe in India, Highest Scheduled Tribes Populated state - Madhya Pradesh.

Q26. When and where did India win its first World Championships medal in Athletics?

- A) 2009, Germany
- B) 2005, Finland
- C) 2007, Japan
- D) 2003, France**

Solution: 15.(d) 2003, France. India won its first World Championships medal in Athletics when Anju Bobby George secured the bronze in the Women's long jump at the 2003 World Championships in Paris. This achievement marked her as the first Indian athlete to win a global athletics medal. World Athletics Championships 2023: India's Gold medal winner - Neeraj Chopra (javelin throw , 88.17 m).

Q27. In which year was tennis included in the Olympic games?

- A) 1927
- B) 1896**
- C) 1935
- D) 1948

Solution: 2.(b) 1896. The first Olympic Games of the modern era took place in Athens, in the country where the original Games took place in Antiquity, in April 1896. Leander Paes is still the only Indian to win an Olympics tennis medal, bagging a men's singles bronze at Atlanta 1996.

Q28. Who among the following is a famous classical dancer?

- A) S Janaki
- B) Sonal Mansingh**
- C) Asha Bhosle
- D) Pratibha Ray

Solution: 4.(b) Sonal Mansingh. She is an Indian classical dancer and Guru in Bharatanatyam and Odissi dancing style. Sista Janaki is an Indian playback singer and occasional music composer from Andhra Pradesh. Asha Bhosle is an Indian singer who records songs for movies. Pratibha Ray is an Indian academic and writer of Odia-language novels and stories.

Q29. The ancient harvest festival of Baisakhi is celebrated in which month of the year?

- A) November
- B) April**
- C) August
- D) January

Solution: 1.(b) April. Baisakhi - The first day of the month of Baisakh and is usually celebrated on the 13th or 14th of April every year. It is the main harvest festival of Punjab state. Other festivals of Punjab: Lohri, Hola Mohalla, Basant Panchmi, Teeyan, Chappar Mela, Jor Mela, Tikka, Gurupurab. Harvest Festivals - Pongal (Tamil Nadu), Lohri (Punjab), Bhogali Bihu (Assam), Poush Parbon (West Bengal), Onam (Kerala).

Q30. Which of the following cities of Nepal does NOT have a branch of 'Indian Citizen's Association of Nepal'?

- A) Pokhara
- B) Lalitpur**
- C) Bhairahawa
- D) Damak

Solution: 12.(b) Lalitpur. An Indian Citizens' Association (ICA) of Nepal was formed on 14 September 1990. This is the only association of resident Indian Citizens of Nepal, and presently the Kathmandu unit of the Association has 462 members. They also have branches at Pokhara, Damak and Bhairahawa. The Swami Vivekananda Centre for Indian Culture was set up in Kathmandu in 2008 to showcase the best of Indian culture. The Nepal-Bharat Library was founded in 1951 in Kathmandu. The India-Nepal Treaty of Peace and Friendship of 1950 forms the bedrock of the special relations that exist between India and Nepal.

Q31. How many field players are in a hockey team?

- A) 14
- B) 7
- C) 11**
- D) 9

Solution: 9.(c) 11. Terms related to Hockey - 16 yard hit, Advancing, Attack (Attacker), Back-line, Bully, Center pass, Clearing, Cross. Trophies related to Hockey - Sahni Trophy, Rene Frank Trophy, Ranjit Singh Gold Cup, Rangaswami Cup (National Hockey Championship), Rangaswami Cup, Obaid Ullah Gold Cup, Nehru Trophy (Hockey Women's), Modi Gold Cup, MCC Trophy.

Q32. In which of the following years was the Pro Kabaddi League established in India?

- A) 2015
- B) 2016
- C) 2013
- D) 2014**

Solution: 4.(d) 2014. Pro Kabaddi is a ground-breaking initiative by Mashal Sports Pvt. Ltd and Disney Star. The inaugural Pro Kabaddi season in 2014 saw eight teams participating in the league. By Season 5, the number of teams competing grew to 12. Pro Kabaddi League (PKL) Winners : Season 1 - Jaipur Pink Panthers, Season 9 - Jaipur Pink Panthers, Season 10 - Puneri Paltan.

Q33. Ustad Shafaat Ahmed Khan was best known for which of the following instruments?

- A) **Tabla**
- B) Rudra Veena
- C) Violin
- D) Harmonium

Solution: 7.(a) Tabla. Ustad Shafaat Ahmed Khan (Delhi gharana). Awards - Padma Shri Award in 2003. Famous Tabla players - Zakir Hussain, Trilok Gurtu, Kishan Maharaj, Alla Rakha. Rudra Veena Player - Asad Ali Khan. Violin - Abhijith P. S. Nair, Ambi Subramaniam, Arrol Carelli, Avaneeswaram S R Vinu. Harmonium Player - Omkar Agnihotri, Lisa Alvarado, Tori Amos.

Q34. Which is the National Mission for Financial Inclusion to ensure access to financial services, namely, a basic savings and deposits accounts, remittance, credit, insurance, pension in an affordable manner?

- A) Deendayal Antyodaya Yojana
- B) Deen Dayal Upadhyaya Grameen Kaushalya Yojana
- C) Swarnjayanti Gram Swarozgar Yojana
- D) **Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana**

Solution: 3.(d) Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana (PMJDY) is a National Mission for Financial Inclusion launched on August 28, 2014. Deendayal Antyodaya Yojana - National Rural Livelihoods Mission (DAY-NRLM): Aim to promote poverty reduction through building strong institutions for the poor, particularly women, and enabling these institutions to access a range of financial services and livelihoods. Deen Dayal Upadhyaya Grameen Kaushalya Yojana (2014): Aims at skill development and placement for rural youth. Swarnjayanti Gram Swarozgar Yojana (1999): A self-employment program for rural poor.

Q35. The 'Kambala' festival is organised by farming communities in the state of _____.

- A) Himachal Pradesh
- B) Rajasthan
- C) **Karnataka**
- D) Madhya Pradesh

Solution: 13.(c) Karnataka. The Kambala festival is essentially associated with the Buffalo race. The festival is dedicated to Hindu God Lord Kadri Manjunatha, who is the epitome of Lord Shiva. Other festivals of Karnataka: Ugadi, Hampi, Karaga, Pattadakal, Kailpodh. Agricultural festivals in other states: Pola (Maharashtra), Nuakhai (Odisha), Onam (Kerala), Wangala (Meghalaya by Garos tribe).

Q36. The National Anti-Doping Bill was passed in the Lok Sabha on July 27, 2022. Which of the following organisation manage and administer doping control programs in India?

- A) **National Anti-Doping Agency (NADA)**
- B) National Adverse Doping Agency (NADA)
- C) National Dope Testing Laboratory (NDTL)
- D) National Doping Control Agency (NDCA)

Solution: 11.(a) National Anti-Doping Agency (NADA) - It was set up as a registered society under the Societies Registration Act of 1860 on November 24, 2005. Headquarters - New Delhi. World Anti-Doping Agency (WADA) : Founded - 10 November 1999. Headquarters: Montreal, Canada.

Q37. The head office of National Bank for Agricultural and Rural Development is located in _____.

- A) Pune
- B) **Mumbai**
- C) Chennai
- D) Kolkata

Solution: 12.(b) Mumbai. NABARD (National Bank for Agricultural and Rural Development) is administered by the Government of India. It was instituted on the recommendations of B.Sivaraman Committee on 12 July 1982 by implementing the National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development Act 1981.

Q38. What is the age criteria for the subscribers of Atal Pension Yojana?

- A) 20 - 30 Years

- B) 25 - 35 Years
- C) **18 - 40 Years**
- D) 40 - 60 Years

Solution: 1.(c) 18-40 Years. Atal Pension Yojana - Launched in 2015 under Ministry of Finance and administered by Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority (PFRDA), mainly focused on providing old age security to the unorganized workers. A minimum guaranteed pension for the subscribers ranging between Rs.1000 - Rs. 5000, depending upon his contribution, at the age of 60 years. Other pension schemes for senior citizens - National Pension System (2004), Pradhan Mantri Vaya Vandana Yojana (2017), Varishtha Pension Bima Yojana (2014), National Social Assistance Programme (1995).

Q39. What will happen when you select the cell contents of a particular row in MS-Excel and then click the Delete button?

- A) First five cell entries will be deleted
- B) Only first three cells will be deleted
- C) Entire row will be deleted
- D) **Entries in all the selected cells will be deleted**

Solution: 10.(d) Entries in all the selected cells will be deleted. Microsoft Excel is a spreadsheet editor developed by Microsoft for Windows, macOS, Android, iOS and iPadOS. It features calculation or computation capabilities, graphing tools, pivot tables, and a macro programming language called Visual Basic for Applications (VBA). Excel forms part of the Microsoft 365 suite of software.

Q40. Jamda folk dance is associated with which Indian state?

- A) Assam
- B) Maharashtra
- C) Manipur
- D) **Jharkhand**

Solution: 1.(d) Jharkhand. Some other folk dances and their states: Jharkhand - Birohr, Paika, Phagua dance, Munderi, Khadia. Assam - Bihu, Bagurumba, Bhortal, Sattriya. Maharashtra - Lavani, Koli, Powadas, Tamasha. Manipur - Pung Cholam, Lai Haraoba, Khamba Thoibi.

Q41. The Sikhs celebrate Bandi Chhorh Divas which coincides with which Hindu festival?

- A) Ganesh Chaturthi
- B) Holi
- C) **Diwali**
- D) Dussehra

Solution: 8.(c) Diwali. Bandi Chhor Divas - A Sikh celebration that commemorates the day on which, the sixth Guru of Sikhs, Guru Hargobind released 52 prisoners from Gwalior Fort, who had been imprisoned by Mughal Emperor Jahangir. Emperor Jahangir had held 52 Kings at Gwalior. Other Sikh Festivals - Muktsar Mela, Parkash Utsav Dasveh Patshah, Holla Mohalla, Gurburab.

Q42. In which year did India make its Olympic debut in hockey?

- A) 1936
- B) 1932
- C) 1924
- D) **1928**

Solution: 2.(d) 1928. India made its Olympic debut in hockey in 1928 at the Amsterdam Olympics. The Indian men's hockey team won their first Olympic gold medal in this tournament, beating the Netherlands. The team was led by captain Jaipal Singh and Dhyan Chand, who scored the most goals with 14. India's hockey team is the most successful in Olympic history, winning eight gold medals in 1928, 1932, 1936, 1948, 1952, 1956, 1964, and 1980.

Q43. 'A Life of the Genius: The Man Who Knew Infinity' is a biography of Indian mathematician _____ .

- A) Acharya Pingala
- B) Aryabhata
- C) **Srinivasa Ramanujan**
- D) Neena Gupta

Solution: 5.(c) Srinivasa Ramanujan:- He is also called 'mathematician of

mathematicians' and 'magician of numbers' for his amazing work on number theory. National Mathematics Day (celebrated on 22 December to commemorate the birth anniversary of Srinivasa Ramanujan). "The Man Who Knew Infinity" is a biography of Ramanujan written by Robert Kanigel. He was the first Indian to receive a fellowship from Trinity College, Cambies. Ramanujan Museum and Mathematics Education Center is located in Chennai (Tamil Nadu).

Q44. Which harvest festival is famously celebrated in Assam?

- A) Bhogali Bihu**
- B) Lohri
- C) Makar Sankranti
- D) Onam

Solution: 6.(a) Bhogali Bihu. Bohag Bihu or Rongali Bihu is one of the biggest festivals of Assam and is celebrated in the month of Baisakh (mid April month) to mark the Assamese New Year. 'Magh Bihu' is celebrated in the month of 'Magh' (in the middle of the month of January) and 'Kati Bihu' is celebrated in the month of Kartik (in the middle of the month of October).

Q45. Padma Shri awardee, Darshana Jhaveri is a _____ dancer of India.

- A) Kathakali
- B) Bharatanatyam
- C) Kathak
- D) Manipuri**

Solution: 15.(d) Manipuri. Darshana Jhaveri is the youngest of the four Jhaveri sisters (Nayana, Ranjana, Suverna, and Darshana). She is one of the founders of the Manipuri Nartanatalaya established in 1972. Awards: Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1996), Padma Shri (2002). Other Manipuri dancers - Yumlembam Gambhini Devi, Guru Bipin Singh (Father of Manipuri Dance).

Q46. Which of the following is NOT one of the harvest festivals celebrated in India?

- A) Onam
- B) Lohri
- C) Baisakhi
- D) Diwali**

Solution: 14.(d) Diwali - It is celebrated during the Hindu lunisolar month Kartika (between mid-October and mid-November), observed on Amavasya (New Moon). Harvest Festivals in India: Makar Sankranti, Baisakhi (Punjab and Haryana), Lohri, Bohag Bihu, Nuakhai (Orissa), Onam (Kerala), Pongal (Tamil Nadu), Vishu (Kerala and Karnataka), Gudi Padwa (Maharashtra, Karnataka and Andhra Pradesh).

Q47. Which of the following institutes was founded by Mrinalini Sarabhai who was a Bharatanatyam and Kathakali dancer?

- A) Sri Thyagaraja College of Music and Dance
- B) Nrityanjali Institute of Performing Arts
- C) Darpana Academy of Performing Arts**
- D) Nalanda Nritya Kala Mahavidyalaya

Solution: 9.(c) Darpana Academy of Performing Arts. It is a school for performing arts in Ahmedabad, Gujarat, established by Mrinalini Sarabhai and Vikram Sarabhai in 1949. Mrinalini Sarabhai's Awards : Padma Bhushan (1992) and Padma Shri (1965).

Q48. In which year was Smart Cities Mission launched?

- A) 2015**
- B) 2013
- C) 2019
- D) 2018

Solution: 13.(a) 2015. It is a Centrally Sponsored Scheme to enhance the quality of life in 100 selected cities by providing efficient services, robust infrastructure, and a sustainable environment. The Central Government has decided to extend the deadline for Smart Cities Mission till 31st March 2025.

Q49. V Satyanarayana Sarma, a Padma Shri awardee, was recognised for which of the following dance forms?

- A) Odissi

- B) Bharatanatyam
- C) Kathak

D) Kuchipudi

Solution: 11.(d) Kuchipudi. Awards : Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1961), Padma Shri (1970), Sangeet Natak Akademi Ratna (1967), Kalidas Samman (1988). A dance-drama performance, with its roots in the ancient Hindu Sanskrit text of Natya Shastra. It originates from a village named Kuchipudi in Andhra Pradesh. Famous Dancers of Kuchipudi - Indrani Bajpai, Yamini Krishnamurthy, Lakshmi Narayn Shastri.

Q50. PM Street Vendor's AtmaNirbhar Nidhi (PM SVANidhi) Scheme was launched by which ministry?

- A) Ministry of Consumer Affairs
- B) Ministry of Finance
- C) Ministry of Commerce
- D) Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs**

Solution: 2.(d) Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs. The PM Street Vendor's Atma Nirbhar Nidhi (PM SVANidhi) - launched on June 01, 2020. Aim - Providing affordable Working Capital loans to street vendors to resume their livelihoods that have been adversely affected due to Covid-19 lockdown.

Q51. Which of the following singer is the recipient of the Dadasaheb Phalke Award?

- A) Sonu Nigam
- B) Asha Bhosle**
- C) Neha Kakkar
- D) Arijit Singh

Solution: 5.(b) Asha Bhosle - She was honored with the Dadasaheb Phalke Award in 2000. Awards - Padma Vibhushan (2008), Maharashtra Bhushan (2021). Awards : Sonu Nigam - Padma Shri (2022). First recipient of Dadasaheb Phalke Award was Devika Rani who received it in 1969.

Q52. Where is Birs Munda International Hockey Stadium located?

- A) Ranchi
- B) Rourkela**
- C) Bhubaneswar
- D) Jamshedpur

Solution: 15.(b) Rourkela (India's largest hockey stadium). Birs Munda was a tribal leader who led the Munda Rebellion against British rule and the exploitation of his people in Jharkhand. Stadiums in India named after famous Personalities: Indira Gandhi Stadium (New Delhi), Rajiv Gandhi International Cricket Stadium (Hyderabad), Narendra Modi Stadium (Ahmedabad), Lal Bahadur Shastri Stadium (Hyderabad), Arun Jaitley Stadium (New Delhi), Major Dhyani Chand Hockey Stadium (Lucknow).

Q53. Which folk music does NOT belong to Nagaland?

- A) Nyioga**
- B) Heliamleu
- C) Hereileu
- D) Neuleu

Solution: 7.(a) Nyioga. It is sung when a marriage ceremony is concluded and the bride's family returns leaving the bride in her home in Arunachal Pradesh. Nagaland's folk music is known for its enchanting melodies and lyrics that tell stories of love, nature, bravery, and cultural identity. Nagaland famous folk dance: Hereileu, Chang Lo, Tetsuo Sisters, Tati, Theku, Asem, Kuki dance.

Q54. Who among the following was a Padma Bhushan awardee, legendary Bharatanatyam exponent, theosophist and founder of the Kalakshetra Dance School?

- A) Sonal Mansingh
- B) Saroja Vaidyanathan
- C) Rukmini Devi Arundale**
- D) Mallika Sarabhai

Solution: 8.(c) Rukmani Devi Arundale: Awards - Padma Bhushan (1956), Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1957), She was nominated in 1952 by the President to be a member of the Rajya Sabha. Sonal Mansingh (Bharatnatyam

and Odissi): Award - Padma Bhushan (1992), Padma Vibhushan (2003), Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1987), founder of Centre for Indian Classical Dances (CICD) in New Delhi. Malika Sarabhai (Bharatnatyam and Kuchipudi): Award - Padma Bhushan (2010), Sangeet natak Akademi award (1999- 2000). Saroja Vaidyanathan (Bharatnatyam Dancer): Awards - Padma Shri (2002), Padma Bhushan (2013).

Q55. Kalakshetra style is associated with which Indian classical dance form?

- A) Odissi
- B) Kathak
- C) Kuchipudi
- D) Bharatanatyam**

Solution: 10.(d) Bharatanatyam. Features:- It encompasses Bhav, Rag, Ras and Taal. Its three important features are Nritya (pure dance, solo), Natya (dramatic dance, group) and Nritya (dance with emotions, solo). It consists of six portions: Alarippu (Invocation), Jathiswaram (Nritya part), Shabdham (Short compositions with word), Varnam (a story, that includes both Nritya and Nritya), Padam (Religious prayer, Bhajan, Keerthanam) and Tillana (Origin in the Tarana of Hindustani Music).

Q56. According to the Indian calendar, Hemanta season falls in which months?

- A) Sravana-Bhadra
- B) Chaitra-Vaisakha
- C) Jyaishta-Asadha
- D) Margashirsa-Pausa**

Solution: 4.(d) Margashirsa - pausa. Other Seasons according to the Hindu Calendar: Basant ritu - Chaitra and Vaisakha, Grishma ritu - Jyeshtha and Aashaadha, Varsha ritu - Shravana and Bhadrapada, Sharad ritu - Ashwin and Kartik, Hemant ritu (pre winter) - Agrahayana and Pausha. Hindu months in chronological order: Chaitra, Vaishakh, Jyeshtha, Aashada, Shraavana, Bhadra, Ashwin, Kartik, Margashirsha, Pausha, Magha, Phalgun.

Q57. In which month of the Islamic calendar is 'Ramadan', a holy time when Muslims around the world fast and focus their attention on giving to charity (known as Zakat), observed?

- A) Ninth**
- B) Second
- C) Seventh
- D) Sixth

Solution: 14.(a) Ninth. Ramadan begins and ends with the appearance of the crescent moon. Islamic months- (1) Muharram, (2) Safar, (3) Rabi al-Awwal, (4) Rabi al-Thani, (5) Jumada al-Awwal, (6) Jumada al-Thani, (7) Rajab, (8) Shaban, (9) Ramadan, (10) Shawwal, (11) Dhu al-Qadah, (12) Dhu al-Hijjah (month of Hajj). Other festivals of Muslims: Muharram, Eid al-Adha, Eid al-Fitr, Mawlid an-Nabi and Eid ul-Azha.

Q58. Neeraj Chopra, Clinched the historic gold at Tokyo Olympics 2020 with a throw of _____ .

- A) 86.58 m
- B) 87.58 m**
- C) 85.58 m
- D) 88.58 m

Solution: 8.(b) 87.58 m. Neeraj Chopra became the first Indian athlete to win an Olympic gold medal in track and field event at the Tokyo Olympics 2020 in Javelin Throw. Other Olympic athletes who win medals:- Weightlifters : Mirabai Chanu (49kg) win Silver medal and Boxer - Lovlina Borgohain - Bronze medal in women's welterweight (64-69 kg). Badminton - PV Sindhu - Bronze medal in women's singles. freestyle wrestling : Ravi Kumar Dahiya - Silver medal in men's 57kg and Bajrang Punia - Bronze medal in men's 65kg. Indian Hockey team : Men's hockey - Bronze medal.

Q59. Kheallam is a famous dance of:

- A) Bihar
- B) Andhra Pradesh
- C) Mizoram**
- D) Uttar Pradesh

Solution: 10.(c) Mizoram. Kheallam (Dance of the Guests) is a dance usually performed in the ceremony called 'Kheangchawi'. Other Dances: Mizoram - Cheraw, Sarlamkai, Solakia, Chailam, Chawnglaizawn, Chheihlam, Tlanglam, Zangtalam. Bihar - Karma, Kajri, Jhumar, Jharni Dance, Jat Jatin. Andhra Pradesh - Dhimsa, Burrakatha. Uttar Pradesh - Charkula, Raslila, Kathak, Ramlila, Khyal, Nautanki.

Q60. In which sport did Mirabai Chanu win India's first Gold Medal at the Commonwealth Games 2022?

- A) Boxing
- B) Archery
- C) Weightlifting**
- D) Shooting

Solution: 9.(c) Weightlifting. Mirabai Chanu won India's first Gold Medal at the Commonwealth Games 2022 in Women's weightlifting India secured 61 medals (22 golds, 16 silvers, and 23 bronzes). Sudhir claimed India's first gold in para sports, and Sanket Sargar won the first medal in 55 Kg men's weightlifting. Venue of Commonwealth Games, 2026 - Victoria, Australia.

Q61. Kathakali is a classical dance of which state?

- A) Andhra Pradesh
- B) Tamil Nadu
- C) Karnataka
- D) Kerala**

Solution: 14.(d) Kerala. Famous dancers of Kathakali - Kalamandalam Gopi, Kalamandalam Krishna Prasad, Kottakal Sivaraman, Kalamandalam Ramankutty Nair, Kalamandalam Vasu Pisharody, Kavungal Chathunni Panicker. There are eight Indian classical dance forms - Bharatnatyam (Tamil Nadu), Kathak (Uttar Pradesh), Kathakali (Kerala), Kuchipudi (Andhra Pradesh), Manipuri (Manipur), Odissi (Odisha), Sattriya (Assam), and Mohiniyattam (Kerala).

Q62. The first modern Olympic Games was held in the year _____

- A) 1894
- B) 1892
- C) 1896**
- D) 1900

Solution: 13.(c) 1896. First modern Olympics held at Athens. The first Winter Games were held in Chamonix (France), in 1924. 2024 Olympics - Paris. 2028 Olympics - Los Angeles (USA). K D Jadhav was India's first wrestler from independent India to win an individual medal in the Olympics (In 1952 Helsinki).

Q63. Which famous book was written by 'Haripala'?

- A) Gita Govinda
- B) Sangeet Darpan
- C) Sangeet Ratnakara
- D) Sangeeta Sudhakara**

Solution: 13.(d) Sangeeta Sudhakara. The term 'Carnatic' and 'Hindustani' to classify musical styles first appeared in it. The Gita Govinda is a work composed by the 12th-century Hindu poet, Jayadeva. Sangeet Darpan is a musical treatise on Indian classical music written by Damodar Pandit. The Sangita-Ratnakara (Ocean of Music and Dance) is one of the most important musicological texts from India.

Q64. Koneru Humpy is associated with which of the following sports?

- A) Chess**
- B) Boxing
- C) Badminton
- D) Cricket

Solution: 13.(a) Chess. Koneru Humpy (Grandmaster): She won three gold medals in the class of girls under -10, 12 and 14 at the World Youth Chess Championship in 1997, 1998 and 2000 respectively. In October 2007, she became the second female player to cross the 2600 Elo rating mark after Judit Polgar (ranked 2606). Awards: Arjuna Award (2003), Padma Shri (2007), BBC Indian Sportswoman of the Year (2021), Sportstar Aces Sportswoman of the Decade (Individual non-Olympic Sports) - 2021, Player of the Chess Tournament at PSPB Inter-unit Chess and Bridge Tournament (Mumbai) -

2022.

Q65. Who among the following players is related to table tennis?

- A) Manish Narwal
- B) Manika Batra**
- C) K Srikanth
- D) Pankaj Advani

Solution: 6.(b) Manika Batra. She is a triple gold medalist at the South Asian Games, a double gold medalist at the Commonwealth Games, and a bronze medalist at the Asian Cup and Asian Games. Her Awards : Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna Award (2020), and Arjuna Award (2018). Other Prominent Table Tennis Players : Achanta Sharath Kamal, Sathiyan Gnanasekaran, Mouna Das, and Neha Aggarwal Sharma. Manish Narwal (Para Pistol Shooter), K Srikanth (badminton player), Pankaj Advani (billiards and snooker).

Q66. Khelo India Winter Games started in which year?

- A) 2022
- B) 2020**
- C) 2019
- D) 2018

Solution: 14.(b) 2020. The first Khelo India Winter Games were held in two legs at two different venues: Leh (Ladakh), Gulmarg (Jammu and Kashmir). Events include: Skiing, alpine skiing, Nordic skiing, Snow rugby, Ice Stock sport, Snow baseball, Mountaineering, Snowshoe running, Ice hockey, Figure skating, and Speed skating. 3rd Khelo India Winter Game 2023: Mascot - The Snow Leopard. Winner : 1st- Jammu and Kashmir (26 Gold, 25 Silver, 25 Bronze). 2nd- Maharashtra (13 Gold, 8 Silver, 6 Bronze).

Q67. Which of the following nations won the seven times women's Asia Cup cricket Championship?

- A) Pakistan
- B) Bangladesh
- C) India**
- D) Sri Lanka

Solution: 14.(c) India. The Women's Asia Cup (Asian Women's Cricket Championships) is a women's One Day International and Twenty20 International cricket tournament. It was established in 2004 and is a biennial tournament. The first Women's Asia Cup was played in Sri Lanka in April 2004. Only two teams took part, India and Sri Lanka. India has won the tournament in the following years: 2004, 2005-06, 2006, 2008, 2012, 2016, and 2022.

Q68. When was the National Urban Health Mission approved by the Government of India?

- A) 2014
- B) 2015
- C) 2012
- D) 2013**

Solution: 5.(d) 2013. The National Urban Health Mission (NUHM): Launched by the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare. Aims - to improve the quality of health care and reduce the disease burden in urban areas. Proposals under the National Urban Health Mission: Urban Primary Health Centre (U-PHC), Urban Community Health Centre (U-CHC), Accredited Social Health Activist (ASHA), Auxiliary Nursing Midwives (ANM).

Q69. Ramappa Temple is dedicated to which God?

- A) Lord Rama
- B) Lord Vishnu
- C) Lord Indra
- D) Lord Shiva**

Solution: 3.(d) Lord Shiva. Ramappa Temple (Rudreshwara Temple or Ramalingeswara Temple) - Situated in Palampet in (Warangal) Telangana. It is a masterpiece of the Kakatiyan style of temple architecture and nominated as a UNESCO World Heritage Site in 2014. Other famous temples (Telangana) - Chilkur Balaji Temple, Sanghi Temple, Gnana Saraswathi Temple, Surendrapuri Temple, Karmanghat Hanuman Temple, Beechupally Anjaneya Swamy Temple.

Q70. Baisakhi Festival is majorly celebrated in the states of ____ and ____.

- A) Nagaland , Tripura
- B) Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh
- C) Punjab, Haryana**
- D) Tamil Nadu, Kerala

Solution: 11.(c) Punjab, Haryana. Baisakhi (harvest festivals) - It falls on the 13th or 14th April every year as a regional holiday. It also commemorates the formation of the Khalsa Panth by Guru Gobind Singh in 1699. Other harvest festivals in india: Lohri (Punjab), Bohag Bihu (Assam), Wangala (Meghalaya and Assam), Ka Pomblang Nongkrem (Meghalaya), Nuakhai (Orissa), Nabanna (West Bengal), Onam (Kerala), Pongal (Tamil Nadu).

Q71. Chapchar kut festival, is a famous festival of _____ state of India.

- A) Tamil Nadu
- B) Mizoram**
- C) Punjab
- D) Uttar Pradesh

Solution: 7.(b) Mizoram. Chapchar Kut is celebrated every year in the month of March after the completion of the Jhum Cultivation. It is a spring festival. Other festivals of Mizoram - Mim Kut (harvest Festival), Pawl Kut (harvest Festival), Lyuva Khutla (Related to Mara tribes), Anthurium Festival (Related to Paite community), Khuado Kut, Hlukhla Kut. Tamilnadu - Pongal Festival, Natyanjali Dance Festival, Karthigai Deepam, Jallikattu Bull Festival. Punjab - Lohri, Baisakhi, Hola Mohalla.

Q72. The maximum distance covered in a marathon is _____.

- A) 40 km
- B) 42.5 km
- C) 42.195 km**
- D) 41.5 km

Solution: 7.(c) 42.195 km. This distance was standardised at 26 miles 385 yards (42.195km) in 1921. The first women's Olympic marathon took place at the 1984 Los Angeles Games. Half-Marathon: 13.1 miles (approximately 21.0975 kilometers). India's Marathon players - Nitendra Singh Rawat, Ram Singh Yadav, Srinu Bugatha, Rashpal Singh.

Q73. Lionel Messi is a famous player of _____ sport.

- A) Basketball
- B) Football**
- C) Badminton
- D) Cricket

Solution: 2.(b) Football. Lionel Andres Messi (Argentine footballer) - He plays for Inter Miami and the Argentina national team as a striker. Famous players - Cristiano Ronaldo, Neymar, Ronaldinho Gaucho, David Beckham. Famous tournaments - FIFA World Cup, UEFA Champions League, UEFA European Championship, FA Cup, Copa America, UEFA Europa League, Africa Cup of Nations.

Q74. Saroja Vaidyanathan received Kalidas Samman for classical dance in _____.

- A) 2009-10**
- B) 2020-21
- C) 2001-02
- D) 2002-03

Solution: 15.(a) 2009-10. Saroja Vaidyanathan (Bharatanatyam). Her awards: Padma Bhushan (2013), Padma Shri (2002). Bharat Kala Sunder (2006). Book by her :- "The Science of Bharatanatyam". Kalidas Samman: It is presented annually by the Government of Madhya Pradesh. Cash prize - 2 lakh rupees . The first recipients (1980) of the Kalidas Samman - Semmangudi Srinivasa Iyer (Classical music) and Mallikarjun Mansur (Classical Music).

Q75. Who among the following Kathak dancers of India founded the KADAMB Centre for Dance in 1964?

- A) Shovana Narayan
- B) Sitara Devi
- C) Rohini Bhate

D) Kumudini Lakhia

Solution: 6.(d) Kumudini Lakhia: Award - Padma Shri (1987), Padma Bhushan (2010), Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1982), Kalidas Samman (2002-03). Other Kathak dancers - Birju Maharaj, Lachu Maharaj, Shovna Narayan, Kumari Kamala, Sunanya Hazarilal Agarwal, Sitara Devi, Rohini Bhate.

Q76. Which of the following is NOT a poverty alleviation programme in India?

A) Rashtriya Uchchar Shiksha Abhiyan

- B) Swarna Jayanti Shahari Rozgar Yojana
- C) Prime Minister Rozgar Yojana
- D) Integrated Rural Development Program

Solution: 12.(a) Rashtriya Uchchar Shiksha Abhiyan. It is a holistic scheme of development for higher education in India initiated in 2013 by the Ministry of Education. Swarna Jayanti Shahari Rozgar Yojana in India is a Centrally Sponsored Scheme which came into effect on 1 December 1997. The Prime Minister Rozgar Yojna (PMRY) scheme is to provide assistance to the educated unemployed persons.

Q77. Buddhadev Dasgupta is famous for playing which of the following musical instruments?

A) Sarod

- B) Sarangi
- C) Bansuri
- D) Mridangam

Solution: 7.(a) Sarod. It is a stringed instrument, used in Hindustani music on the Indian subcontinent. Buddhadev Das Gupta was an Indian classical musician. His Awards: Padma Bhushan (2012) and Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1993). Notable exponents of the Sarod : Ustad Amjad Ali Khan, Bahadur Khan, and Allaudin Khan.

Q78. Pandit Kishan Maharaj of Benaras Gharana was a _____ player.

- A) santoor
- B) flute
- C) sarangi
- D) tabla

Solution: 6.(d) Tabla. Awards of Kishan Maharaj - Padma Shri (1973), Padma Vibhushan (2002). Hariprasad Chaurasia (Padma Bhushan in 1992, Padma Vibhushan in 2000) - An Indian music director and classical flutist. Pandit Shivkumar Sharma (Padma Shri in 1991, and Padma Vibhushan in 2001) - Santoor player. Ram Narayan (Padma Shri in 1976, Padma Bhushan in 1991, and Padma Vibhushan in 2005) - Sarangi player.

Q79. Which festival traces its origin to the Tibetan New Year and in Ladakh, it is celebrated every year at the end of the harvesting season?

A) Losar festival

- B) Matho Nagrang
- C) Yuru Kabgyat
- D) Dosmoche

Solution: 12.(a) Losar festival: It is celebrated in India in various parts such as Arunachal Pradesh, Ladakh, Sikkim, The Lahaul district of Himachal Pradesh. It marks the beginning of the Tibetan new year. It is usually celebrated by the tribes who believe in the Mahayana sect of Buddhism like the Sherdukpens, Khamba, Memba, Monpa tribe, etc. Other Festivals of Ladakh - Hemis Festival, Sindhu Darshan, Phyang Tsedup Festival, Tak Tok Festival, Matho Nagrang Festival.

Q80. Under the PL 480 scheme, India used to import wheat from which country?

- A) USSR
- B) USA
- C) France
- D) UK

Solution: 9.(b) USA. After independence, India relied on food crop supplies from the United States under Public Law 480 (PL-480) against rupee payments. The P. L. 480 agreements aim at supply of surplus agricultural

commodities from the U.S.A.

Q81. Which state government launched the "Panchamrut Yojana"?

- A) Karnataka
- B) Odisha
- C) West Bengal
- D) Uttar Pradesh

Solution: 10.(d) Uttar Pradesh. The Panchamrut scheme seeks to reduce the production cost of sugarcane, as well as increase productivity and the fertility of the land. Five approaches - An integrated trench method for sowing of sugarcane, ratoon management and trash mulching, drip irrigation and co-cropping. Other schemes - Kanya Vidya Dhan Yojna, Uttar Pradesh Divyang Shadi Yojana.

Q82. The government launched the Stand-Up India scheme to promote entrepreneurship among _____.

- A) Disabled Individuals
- B) Transgender community
- C) Elderly Individuals
- D) Women and SC/ST communities

Solution: 10.(d) Women and SC/ST communities. Stand up India Scheme was launched on April 05, 2016. The scheme has been extended till 2025. Objective: Facilitate bank loans between Rs 10 lakh and Rs 1 crore to at least one SC/ST borrower and at least one woman borrower per bank branch of Scheduled Commercial Banks. Startup India: Launch Date: January 16, 2016. Objective: Promote innovation and entrepreneurship in India. Digital India: Launch Date: July 1, 2015. Objective: Digitally empower Indian citizens and improve online infrastructure and services nationwide.

Q83. Match the following musical instruments with the maestros who play them. a. Santoor i. Bismillah Khan b. Sitar ii. Ustad Binda Khan c. Shehnai iii. Pt Shiv Kumar Sharma d. Sarangi iv. Anushka Shankar

- A) a-ii, b-iii, c-i, d-iv
- B) a-iv, b-iii, c-ii, d-i
- C) a-iii, b-iv, c-i, d-ii
- D) a-i, b-ii, c-iii, d-iv

Solution: 3.(c) a-iii, b-iv, c-i, d-ii. Famous musical instruments and their exponents: Santoor - Bhajan Sopori, Pt Tarun Bhattacharya. Sitar - Ustad Vilayat Khan, Pt Ravi Shankar, Shujaat Hussain Khan, Shahid Parvez Khan, Anushka Shankar, Nikhil Banerjee, Mustaq Ali Khan, Budhaditya Mukherjee. Shehnai - Daya Shankar, Ali Ahmad Hussain. Sarangi: Abdul Latif Khan, Ramesh Mishra, Sultan Khan, Pt Ram Narayan, Shakoor Khan.

Q84. With respect to sports, WADA stands for _____ .

- A) World Anti-Doping Association
- B) World Anti-Doping Agency
- C) Wrestling Anti-Doping Association
- D) World Autonomous - Doping Agency

Solution: 15.(b) World Anti-Doping Agency - It was established in 1999 as an international independent agency composed and funded equally by the sport movement and governments of the world. The First World Conference on Doping in Sport held in Lausanne (Switzerland) in 1999. Headquarter - Montreal, Canada.

Q85. Match List-I (Name of the composition) with List-II (Writer).

- A) 1-C, 2-A, 3-B
- B) 1-B, 2-C, 3-A
- C) 1-C, 2-B, 3-A
- D) 1-A, 2-B, 3-C

Solution: 5.(b) 1-B, 2-C, 3-A. "Aye Mere Watan Ke Logo" is a patriotic song written in Hindi by Kavi Pradeep, composed by C. Ramchandra, and sung by singer Lata Mangeshkar. Jana Gana Mana is the national anthem of the Republic of India. It was originally composed as "Bharoto Bhagyo Bidhata" in Bengali by polymath Rabindranath Tagore on 11 December 1911. "Vande Mataram" is a Bengali poem by Bankim Chandra Chatterjee.

Q86. When was the Bharat Nirman Programme launched by the Government of India?

- A) 2014
- B) 2005**
- C) 2010
- D) 2000

Solution: 11.(b) 2005. The Bharat Nirman program was a Union Government program launched to improve rural infrastructure. The program's objectives included: Developing rural roads, Building rural housing, Improving rural telephony, Electrifying rural areas, and Providing rural water supply and irrigation.

Q87. Who among the following was the first Chief Election Commissioner of India?

- A) Dr. Nagendra Singh
- B) SP Sen Verma
- C) Sukumar Sen**
- D) KVK Sundaram

Solution: 11.(c) Sukumar Sen. Part XV (Article 324-329): It deals with elections, and election commission. 25th Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) of India - Rajiv kumar. The President appoints CEC and Election Commissioners. Dr. Nagendra Singh - The First Indian to be the President of the International Court of Justice from the year 1985 to 1988. KVK Sundaram - Second Chief Election Commissioner of India. SP Sen Verma - 3rd Chief Election Commissioner of India.

Q88. V. Satyanarayana Sarma was awarded with Padma Shri in 1970 for his contributions in the field of ____ dance

- A) Kuchipudi**
- B) Odissi
- C) Manipuri
- D) Kathak

Solution: 12.(a) Kuchipudi - It originates from a village named Kuchipudi (Andhra Pradesh). V. Satyanarayana Sarma: Awards - Padma Shri (1970), Sangeet Natak Akademi Fellowship (1967) , Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1961) , Kalidas Samman (1988). Eight classical dances in india (by the Sangeet Natak Akademi) - Bharatanatyam (Tamil Nadu), Kathak (Uttar Pradesh), Kathakali (Kerala), Kuchipudi (Andhra Pradesh), Manipuri (Manipur), Mohiniyattam (Kerala), Odissi (Odisha), Sattriya (Assam).

Q89. How many main styles of Chhau folk dance exist?

- A) 7
- B) 3**
- C) 9
- D) 5

Solution: 2.(b) 3. Chhau - A classical Indian dance with martial, tribal and folk traditions, with origins in eastern India (Jharkhand, West Bengal and Odisha). The dancer remains mute, with no singing involved. Types of Chhau dance forms - Saraikeela (Jharkhand), Mayurbhanj (Orissa) and Purulia (West Bengal). The dance was inscribed in the UNESCO's Representative List of the Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity in 2010.

Q90. On what type of data can MS Excel functions operate?

- A) External data sources only
- B) Entire worksheets only
- C) Range of cells or groups of cells**
- D) Individual cells only

Solution: 9.(c) Range of cells or groups of cells. MS Excel, a worksheet, also known as a Spreadsheet, is a table into which you enter data and data label. Worksheet used in Excel documents is a collection of cells organized in rows and columns. It is the working surface you interact with to enter data. Each worksheet contains 1048576 rows and 16384 columns and serves as a giant table that allows you to organize information.